

Students not too keen to read up on the content can use the video and audio recording of Dr Herman's lectures on the subject. These are accessible from the "Audio/Video Lectures" link on the main page. The Video Lectures are accessible through a link offered in the first part of the page. The Video files are in the WMV, MP4 or RAM formats. For offline viewing, the MP4 format can be downloaded, while for viewing the lectures as an online stream, the WMV and RAM links can be used. A couple of the links of the video recordings are broken. The downloadable video is available only in 160 x 128 resolution, and the quality is basic. Besides the video recording, students can also look at the images of the blackboard as used by Dr Herman. The Audio lectures also are available in downloadable and online streaming format. Downloadable files are in MP3 format. The quality of the audio recordings are not up to the mark, probably because the compression adversely affected the original quality. But, with some effort, the message can be comprehended. The accent would, probably, be the biggest hindrance for most students.

In conclusion, Dr Herman's approach of delivering a complete learning experience, by selectively using the available free resources on the Net, and the free resources offered by a publisher who doesn't offer the textbook for free, and by offering video and audio recordings of his lectures is an excellent example of exploiting the power of the Net to make education free. It is an ingenious idea and a commendable effort.

1.7 Learning Aids—Applets and Animations.

1.7.1 Physics Applets

(http://qbx6.ltu.edu/s_schneider/physlets/main/index.shtml)

This is the contribution of Dr Scott Schneider, associate professor of physics at Lawrence Technological University. On this page, Dr Schneider has offered Java Applets that can be used to better understand various physics concepts. The Java